TOWNSHIP OF LINCOLN
CLARE COUNTY, P.O. BOX 239
LAKE GEORGE, MI 48633

Supervisor, Dennis Zimmerman
Clerk, Carol Majewski
Treasurer, Maggie Carey
Trustee, Jerry Bridges
Trustee, Mike Tobin

Lincoln Township Zoning Board of Appeals
Annual Meeting
Wednesday, April 8, 2015

The meeting was called to order by Chair Godau at 7:00 pm.

Roll Call:
Present – Chair Godau, Vice-Chair Swanson, Bridges, Engelhardt, Smith, McCaslin, Recording Secretary Sherrod
Absent – Zoning Administrator Carey (excused) Secretary Szczepanski (excused)
Public – 0

Approval of Minutes:
Regular Meeting minutes of March 11, 2015 – It was moved by Bridges and seconded by Engelhardt to accept the minutes as corrected for time of adjournment (5:50 pm corrected to read 8:50 pm) . Motion passed unanimously.

General Comments from Chair Godau:
1. Chair Godau presented the Board with a policy concerning the use of social media by Lincoln Township employees and representatives that he was given by township treasurer Maggie Carey.
2. Chair Godau also brought up the Lincoln Township ZBA Rules and Procedures to make sure that everyone on the board has them and has had time to review them. A discussion concerning the responsibilities of secretary and recording secretary followed.

Election of Officers:
a. Bridges made a motion to leave the Chair and Vice-Chair as is, with Tom Godau as Chair and Marshall Swanson as Vice-Chair. Engelhardt seconded. Motion passed unanimously.

b. Godau made a motion to nominate Cindy Engelhardt as Secretary, Bridges seconded. Motion passed unanimously.

New Business:

1. Chair Godau brought up the procedures of how motions are made and acted upon during hearings and then how different scenarios are handled in the cases of split votes, multiple motions, the ability to table a request in the case of an impasse, etc. Bridges and Smith explained that sometimes in the case of an impasse, the issue will need to be addressed at a future meeting.
2. Future Training Options: Chair Godau presented information on training sessions available through the township. He asked the board to look over the information and to get back to him.
3. Schedule of Required Meetings:

The schedule will be set at the next meeting.

Public Comments:

Kim Smith asked as a public attendee: Does the ZBA think they ever will approve a variance? Bridges and Godau both said that they would not rule out that possibility. Engelhardt stated that with the requirements to meet the five conditions it would not be impossible to approve a variance, but it would not be a simple issue. She stated that this type of problem in the future will be corrected with the major revisions in the ordinances currently underway. Bridges stated that the current ordinances are the only thing we have to interpret and we are bound by those.

Motion to adjourn was made by Bridges, seconded by Swanson. Meeting adjourned at 8:17 pm by Chair Godau.

Respectfully Submitted,

Secretary Engelhardt